Séquence 6

College sports in the USA

Sommaire

Objectifs de la séquence
1. Getting to know the American school system
2. Understanding a literary text about college life
3. Examining how to defend your ideas orally
4. Developing your speaking skills
5. Extending your knowledge of American culture
6. On the road to autonomy
7. Évaluations

"Our philosophy precedes from the belief that sport is an inalienable part of the educational process and a factor for promoting peace, friendship, cooperation and understanding among peoples."

Juan Antonio Samaranch
(President of the International Olympic Committee, 1980-2001)

"Sport is a very important subject at school, that's why I gave Quidditch such an important place at Hogwarts. I was very bad in sports, so I gave Harry a talent I would have really loved to have. Who wouldn't want to fly?"

J.K. Rowling, author of *Harry Potter,* b. 1965.

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Objectifs de la séquence

Dans cette séquence de cours, vous allez apprendre à prendre la parole pour défendre votre vision de la place des activités dites « extrascolaires » dans l'éducation.

Pour cela, des activités vous seront proposées à partir de documents factuels ou littéraires liés aux sports et à l'enseignement à l'américaine, pour vous informer et vous aider à développer vos compétences en audition, en lecture et en expression orale et écrite.

1. Get ready: getting to know the American school system

Vous allez faire le point sur ce que vous savez déjà du système éducatif américain, et approfondir vos connaissances aussi bien sur le plan culturel que lexical, en vous mettant dans la situation d'un lycéen américain sur le point de commencer ses études universitaires.

2. Understanding a literary text about college life

Vous allez développer des stratégies de compréhension écrite : les repérages de base transférables à tout document, puis la création de liens pour construire le sens global. Une fois que vous aurez identifié le contexte et le contenu du passsage, vous réfléchirez aux techniques d'inférence pour surmonter le problème du lexique inconnu et pour développer votre compréhension de l'implicite. Pour finir, vous prendrez du recul pour réfléchir à l'intention de l'auteur.

3. Examining how to defend your ideas orally

Vous allez d'abord étudier un extrait de roman pour comprendre le contexte avant d'analyser à partir d'un texte écrit l'organisation, les techniques oratoires, avant de vous exercer à l'identification de l'intonation, pour ensuite vous exercer au passage à oral et à la mise en bouche.

4. Developing your speaking skills

Vous allez mettre en application les stratégies de prise de parole travaillées en amont, en développant vos savoirs linguistiques et votre capacité à passer de notes écrites à une prise de parole naturelle.

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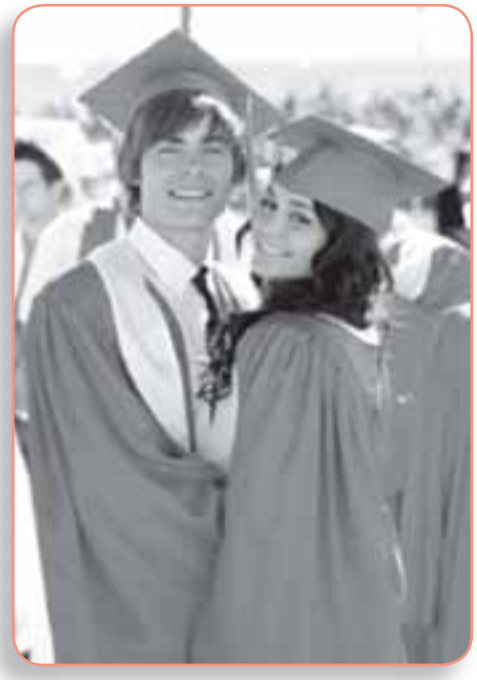
5. Extending your knowledge of American culture

Vous allez mettre en application les stratégies de compréhension écrite développées en amont, en travaillant la qualité de votre expression à l'écrit et en réfléchissant aux faits culturels qui forment la toile de fond du passage étudié.

6. On the road to autonomy

Vous allez vous entraîner à une prise de parole en continu dans le but de convaincre de se ranger à votre avis. Vous allez d'abord prendre connaissance de la situation et réfléchir à la mobilisation des idées et des éléments linguistiques nécessaires avant de mettre en application tout ce que vous avez appris dans cette séquence.



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1 Getting to know the American school system

Activity 1

Here is a series of short quizzes to establish how well you already know the American School system:

❶ The basic facts

Match the British terms with their American equivalents:

assembly	○	○	schedule
break	○	○	grade
form room	○	○	faculty
mark	○	○	locker time
staff	○	○	quarter
term	○	○	home room
timetable	○	○	prayer and pledge

❷ Some frequent confusions

Tick the correct answer(s).

▸ **a.** "school" in the USA refers to

❒ an establishment for children aged 6-11

❒ an establishment for children aged 11-14

❒ an establishment for children aged 14-18

❒ an establishment for people over 18

▸ **b.** "college" in the USA refers to

❒ an establishment for children aged 6-11

❒ an establishment for children aged 11-14

❒ an establishment for children aged 14-18

❒ an establishment for people over 18

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- **c.** At “college” students receive
  - ❒ an Associate’s Degree (after 2 years)
  - ❒ a Bachelor’s Degree (after 4 years)
  - ❒ a Master’s Degree (after 5/6 years)
  - ❒ a Doctorate (after 8 years)
- **d.** At “university” students receive
  - ❒ an Associate’s Degree (after 2 years)
  - ❒ a Bachelor’s Degree (after 4 years)
  - ❒ a Master’s Degree (after 5/6 years)
  - ❒ a Doctorate (after 8 years)
- **e.** Undergraduate education corresponds to
  - ❒ an Associate’s Degree (after 2 years)
  - ❒ a Bachelor’s Degree (after 4 years)
  - ❒ a Master’s Degree (after 5/6 years)
  - ❒ a Doctorate (after 8 years)
- **f.** Postgraduate education corresponds to
  - ❒ an Associate’s Degree (after 2 years)
  - ❒ a Bachelor’s Degree (after 4 years)
  - ❒ a Master’s Degree (after 5/6 years)
  - ❒ a Doctorate (after 8 years)
- **g.** “The Ivy League” refers to
  - ❒ a university football league
  - ❒ a program of sports tournaments at university level
  - ❒ the eight most select universities in the USA
  - ❒ the climbing plant that decorates old university
  - ❒ buildings

Check your answers.

Make sure you read the factfiles carefully:
they will help you understand the documents!

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FACT FILE

Students in high school or college / university have different names according to their level:

Freshman = first year Sophomore = second year
Junior = third year Senior = fourth year

Work is assessed with grades:

	equivalent in %	GPA* (*Grade point average)
A	93-100	4.00
B+	90-92	3.50
B	86-89	3.00
B-	84-85	2.75
C+	81-83	2.50
C	74-80	2.00
C-	72-73	1.75
D+	70-71	1.50
D	67-69	1.00
F	0-66	0.00

- Students who obtain a GPA of 3.67 or more every quarter are inscribed in the Academic Hall of Fame of the school;
- Students who obtain a GPA of 3.5 or higher may enter the National Honor Society or the National Beta Club, on condition that they excel in leadership, character and service as well.

Many colleges require students to present their results in college entrance tests:
SATs (Scholastic Aptitude Tests): multiple choice questions divided into two principal sections, verbal and mathematical.
ACTs (American College Testing): multiple choice questions divided into English, Mathematics, Reading, and Science.
High school students can also gain extra credits for college by doing Advanced Placement courses, which can also help them obtain a scholarship (*bourse au mérite*).

An example of a high school schedule:

	7:53	Rooms open
	7:58	Prayer and pledge
8:00	8:15	Home room and Channel 1
8:18	9:00	Period 1
9:03	9:45	Period2
9:48	10:30	Period 3
10:30	10:34	Locker time
10:34	11:16	Period 4
11:19	11:44	Lunch A / period 5
11:47	12:29	Period 5 / lunch B / period 6
12:32	1:14	Period 6 / lunch C
1:14	1:18	Locker time
1:18	2:01	Period 7
2:04	2:46	Period 8

Each student follows 7 classes at the same time every day; when he is not in class, he is in Study Hall.
There are three periods for lunch: each student eats at the same period every day.
Most students remain at school after 3p.m. to pursue co-curricular activities such as Sports, Music, Theater, the Environmental Club, etc.

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Activity 2

Imagine you have the opportunity to pursue your studies in the USA. Here is an admission form for you to complete.

As you complete it, list all the elements that you do not think a French University would ask about:

APPLICATION FOR COLLEGE ADMISSION

Application Fee: $25

Application status

Student classification:

❒ First time freshman ❒ Transfer student ❒ Transient (Visiting) ❒ student

Term you wish to enter: Year 20.....

❒ Fall (September) ❒ Winter (January) ❒ Spring (March) ❒ Summer (June)

Personal Data

.....

First Name (Preferred Name) Middle or Maiden Name Last Name

.....

Address City

.....

Country State Zip

.....

Date of Birth City and State of Birth

.....

Telephone Number Social Security Number

.....

E-mail address Are you a U.S. citizen? ❒ Yes ❒ No

If no, are you a permanent resident? ❒ Yes ❒ No

Please check appropriate boxes ❒ Female ❒ Male ❒ Single ❒ Married

Family information

.....

Name of (❒ Father, ❒ Husband, ❒ Guardian) ❒ Living ❒ Deceased

.....

Occupation Firm/Company Home Telephone Number

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Home Address City

State Zip

With whom do you live: ❒ Mother and Father, ❒ Mother, ❒ Father, ❒ Guardian,
❒ Other: .....

Please list family members who have attended or are currently attending this College.

Name Relationship Dates Attended/Attending

High School activities

Please list your high school extracurricular activities (refer to activity codes below):

- ❒ Art
- ❒ Community service: Please specify
- ❒ Drama
- ❒ Honoraries: Please specify
- ❒ Music:
  - ❒ Band-Instruments
  - ❒ Orchestra-Instruments
  - ❒ Vocal-Voice Part
- ❒ Officer in school organization: Please specify .....
- ❒ Speech/Media: Please specify .....
- ❒ Student government
- ❒ Varsity sports you plan to play in college
- ❒ Other, such as special events[1] planning (Homecoming, Prom, etc.): Please specify .....

1. special events in US high schools include:
Homecoming: a traditional annual reunion to welcome back former students (alumni)
Proms: a formal dance held for a high-school or college class usually at the end of the academic year

Activity codes

Music

A Flute/Piccolo
B Clarinet/Bass clarinet
C Oboe
D Bassoon
E Saxophone(s)
N Tenor
O Bass
P Piano
Q Organ
R Violin

Varsity Sports

B Baseball
K Basketball
C Cross Country
F Football
G Golf

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F	French horn/Marching horns	S	Viola	S	Soccer
G	Trumpet/Cornet	T	Cello	O	Softball
H	Trombone	*	String bass/Electric guitar	E	Tennis
I	Baritone/Euphonium	*	Classical guitar/Electric guitar	T	Track
J	Tuba/Sousaphone	W	Flag corps/Silks/Colorguard	V	Volleyball
K	Percussion/Mallets/Set	X	Drill team		
L	Soprano	Y	Drum major/Field commander		
M	Alto	Z	Majorette/Featured twirler		

Are you interested in our Dance minor? ❒ Yes ❒ No

Do you plan to participate in Music activities in college? ❒ Yes ❒ No

Financial aid

Do you plan to apply for financial aid? ❒ Yes ❒ No

Do you qualify for Employee Tuition Benefit? ❒ Yes ❒ No

Do you plan to: ❒ live in a campus residence hall ❒ commute from parents' home* ❒ commute from other*

*NOTE: Commuting students must live within a 30 mile radius of the College.

Optional: racial/ethnic/religious

This section is optional: the information is requested so that we can refer you to scholarships available to students meeting designated criteria. Please check all that apply.

Racial/Ethnic Background:

❒ African American
❒ Asian American/Pacific Islander American
❒ Caucasian
❒ Hispanic American
❒ Native American (American Indian or Alaskan Native)
❒ Multi racial (please specify)
❒ Other (please specify)

Religious Preference:

❒ Baptist
❒ Jewish
❒ Lutheran
❒ Presbyterian
❒ Roman Catholic
❒ Methodist
❒ Other

Academic history

.....

Name of High School Year of Graduation

.....

Name of Guidance Counselor Telephone Number of High School

Have you taken the ACT (American College Testing Program test)? ❒ Yes ❒ No When? .....

Have you taken the SAT (Scholastic Aptitude Test)? ❒ Yes ❒ No When? .....

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Please list all previous colleges attended.

.....

Institution (City, State) Dates Attended Degree

.....

Institution (City, State) Dates Attended Degree

.....

Post Secondary Institution Dates Attended Courses

If you are not currently attending a school, please describe your activities since you were last enrolled: (Example: work, travel, etc.)

I hereby apply for admission to XXXXXXXXX College, and acknowledge that all the information in this application is complete, accurate and honestly presented to the best of my knowledge.

.....

Signature of Applicant Date

Please enclose any additional information you may deem necessary for your admission to XXXXXXXXX. Pictures are optional.

XXXXXXXXX College does not discriminate on the basis of sex, race, creed, gender, sexual orientation, age, political affiliation, national origin, or disabling condition in admission of students, education policies, financial aid and scholarships, housing, athletics, employment or other activities.

Use the envelope provided or mail your application to:

XXXXXXXXX College Office of Admission,
One XXXXXXXXX College,
Washington, DC 20001

Check your list of elements which a French University would not ask about.

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Activity 3

❶ **Take a look at these pictures representative of major events in the school year in an American school (high school or college).**

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FACT FILE

A school's success rate is measured not only in terms of the number of students who graduate (= leave school) with excellent results, but also in terms of its sporting results in championships with other schools in the district, the county, the state or even the nation. Every match, whatever the sport, the school turns out to defend its colours, not just during the match, but before with the cheerleaders and the school marching band. In other words, even if a student is not particularly athletic, he can play a major role at a school sports meeting through music. The matches are followed not only by the students and faculty, but also by parents and alumni (former students). The bigger the school or university, the greater the number of supporters: at university level, supporters will wear the university colours at the matches or even on a day to day level to demonstrate their loyalty.

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❷ Now that your are more familiar with the American school system, decide how you would answer these questions posted on a website for high school graduates hoping to go to college.

FAQs *(Frequently Asked Questions)*

- **1.** I play sports, so it's okay if my GPA is a little weak. ❒ True ❒ False
- **2.** It will look better on my application if I volunteer at a homeless shelter than if I am a member of the drama club. ❒ True ❒ False
- **3.** When it comes to getting into college, the more clubs I join, sports I play, and volunteering I do, the better! ❒ True ❒ False
- **4.** When I mention an activity on my application, it's important to give details. ❒ True ❒ False
- **5.** Since I'm an athlete and I want to play in college, I'll need to go through a different admissions process. ❒ True ❒ False

Check your answers.

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2 Understanding a literary text about college life

Activity 4

Read this extract from *Whale Talk*, and do the activities that follow:

1 Read the text a first time to familiarize yourself with it. Then read it again highlighting all the references to people, underlining the references to places and boxing the temporal references (references to time).

The following meets are carbon copies of the first, except Icko keeps the bus on the road. I swim the fifty and hundred, or the hundred and two hundred, and win every time. The other guys swim whichever events will bring us the most points, establishing times in races they haven't swum before and bettering their times in those they have. As long as no one falls asleep in the water, we're all a good bet to get faster and faster. Improved stroke technique alone will keep everyone in the running, not to mention the monster conditioning.

What I like about the meets more than the swimming, though, is the bus ride. When Icko pulls the door shut and fires up the engine, it feels almost cocoonlike. We talk about things we'd probably never mention in any other arena: Simon's mother drinks like a fish, Mott spent most of middle school in drug rehab, Tay Roy [Kibble] lost a baby brother to SIDS, Dan Hole's father has heart trouble, Chris [Coughlin]'s aunt plays bingo, and Jackie Craig may or may not have a voice box. Simet and Icko let us talk, feeding questions once in a while to keep the conversation going, but never intruding.

It gets to be ritual; a half hour before we reach our destination, Simet begins going over each of our races, so between then and the end of the meet, we talk or think nothing but swimming. Then we stop at some local pizza place and, depending on how much time we have, eat there or take it on the bus with us.

Toward the end of the semester it becomes clear we may have problems with academic eligibility. "I've been doing the responsible thing," Coach says, walking to the back of the bus to remove Mott's headphones, "and it appears a couple of you are in danger of failing one or more classes. Mr. Mott is in danger of passing one. Hey, guys, this is serious business. You have to carry a two-oh average, and you have to be passing every class."

Mott says, "I'm going light on the academic thing this year."

Coach says, "You were until a minute ago. Now you're going heavy." He

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removes a folded sheet of paper from his pocket, holds it to one side to catch the light from the dashboard, squinting to read. “Mr. Hole, Mr. Jones, and Mr. Coughlin, you’re all in great shape. Mr. DeLong, you are walking the edge in biology. Mr. Craig, you’re three percentage points under in speech. Mr. Kibble, you don’t seem able to remember your valences and the periodic table of elements in chem, and Mr. Mott, you are exactly one percentage point below passing in six classes.” He stares at the page. “Mott, how do you do that?”

“It isn’t easy, sir. I have to keep close track. Last week I got luckier than usual on an American history pop quiz and my grade slipped up over passing. Scared me.”

“Well, if that scared you, prepare to be terrified, because before this semester ends, you are going to bring every one of those grades at least to a C.” He turns to Jackie. “Mr, Craig, what is your problem in speech?”

Jackie shrugs.

“That might be it right there,” Simet says. “Mr. DeLong?”

Simon says, “Biology is right before first lunch. I start seeing the things we’re cutting up on my plate, and pretty soon I just have to get out of there.”

Chris Crutcher, *Whale talk*, 2001

❷ Determine what aspect of college life the passage centres on:

.....

❸ The extract is a mixture of narrative and dialogue.

Who speaks in lines 40-42: .....

lines 43-45: .....

❹ a. Make notes on the characters:

Name	Family details	Other information

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b. Who are adults?

.....

5 Look carefully at the context to establish the meaning of the following words or expressions:

l.1 & l.9	*meets*	means:	❒ encounters	❒ competitions	❒ reunions ❒ meals
l.1	*are carbon copies*	means:	❒ are different	❒ are black	❒ are identical
l.37	*chem*	means:	❒ chemotherapy	❒ chemistry	❒ chimney

6 True or false? Justify by quoting the text.

- **a. The narrator's team regularly improve the results in their sport.**

  ❒ True ❒ False .....

- **b. Their sport is running.**

  ❒ True ❒ False .....

- **c. When they talk on the bus, they tell each other confidences.**

  ❒ True ❒ False .....

- **d. Simet and Icko never say anything during these moments.**

  ❒ True ❒ False .....

- **e. The coach is concerned about their academic results.**

  ❒ True ❒ False .....

7 Pick out two sentences in the text to elucidate the term 'academic eligibility':

.....

.....

8 For each student mentioned, determine his performance and put his name in the correct category.

	Very good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory
Sports results			
School results			

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9 For each of the following characters, choose the adjective which best defines his character and quote the text to justify:

- **a.** Mott : ❒ serious ❒ comic

  .....

- **b.** Simet: ❒ methodical ❒ disorganised

  .....

- **c.** Simet: ❒ indulgent ❒ demanding (*exigeant*)

  .....

10 Choose between these two titles for the extract and justify your choice:

❒ High school sports heroes ❒ High school anti-heroes

.....

Language work

Before you move on to the next part, take time to learn any vocabulary you did not know.

Do these two quick exercises to check:

Match the antonyms:

to pass	to fail
light	comic
serious	to forget
to remember	to lose
to win	heavy

Match the synonyms:

a couple	a problem
to be in danger	below
to improve	to better
trouble	to risk
under	two

Check your answers.

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Comment s'organiser pour réussir une compréhension écrite ?

Il faut procéder par étapes comme vous venez de faire avec cet extrait.

1. Anticiper sur le contenu (= mobiliser vos idées, et réfléchir aux mots-clés en anglais par rapport au contexte annoncé –l'introduction, les éventuelles images, le sujet etc.)

Lors de lectures successives :

2. Repérer les mots-clés (personnes, lieux, répétitions, même champ sémantique…)
3. Opérer un classement de ces mots-clés et repérer les informations essentielles pour chacun d'eux.
4. S'il y a des pronoms, repérer à quoi ils renvoient.
5. Rassembler toutes les informations recueillies et essayer de reconstruire le sens du document en prenant en compte la dimension culturelle (et vos connaissances générales).
6. Focaliser sur l'attitude des interlocuteurs et essayer d'identifier leurs intentions.
7. Dans le cas de mot important inconnu, réfléchir au sens possible par rapport au sujet, au contexte dans lequel le mot est utilisé, à la construction du mot (composition ou dérivation) et au contexte au sens large (dimension culturelle).
8. Résumer ce que vous avez compris (et relire si vous avez l'impression qu'il vous manque des éléments essentiels).

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3 Examining how to defend your ideas orally

In this part, we will study a literary text to see how two characters express their ideas orally, before trying to do the same.

Activity 5

See how well you can put into practice the methodology you saw in Activity 4 to understand this text.

1 Read the text a first time to familiarize yourself with it. Then read it again highlighting all the references to people, underlining the references to places and boxing the temporal references (references to time).

When word got out that a senior at the high school, a girl named Charlotte Simmons would be going to Dupont in the fall, it was front page news in *The Alleghany News*, the weekly newspaper.

A month or so later, one Saturday morning at the end of May, with the high school's commencement exercises under way in the gymnasium, that particular girl, Charlotte Simmons, was very much a star. The principal, Mr. Thoms, was at the podium up on the stage at one end of the basketball court. He had already mentioned, in the course of announcing the various citations for excellence, that Charlotte Simmons had won the French prize, the English prize, and the creative writing prize. Now he was introducing her as the student who would deliver the valedictory address.

"... a young woman who well, ordinarily we never mention SAT scores here at the school, first, because that's confidential information, and second, because we don't like to put that much emphasis on SATs in the first place" – he paused and broke into a broad smile and beamed it across the entire audience – "but just this once, I have to make an exception. I can't help it. This is a young woman who scored a perfect sixteen hundred on the SAT and perfect fives on four different advanced placement tests, a young woman who was chosen as one of North Carolina's two Presidential Scholars and went to Washington, to the White House – along with Martha Pennington of our English department, who was honored as her mentor and met with the ninety eight students and their mentors representing the other forty nine states of our nation and had dinner with the President and shook hands with him, a young woman who, in addition, was one of the stars of our cross country team, a young woman who."

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The subject of all this attention sat in a wooden folding chair in the first row of the ranks of the senior class, her heart beating fast as a bird's. It wasn't that she was worried about the speech she was about to give. She had gone over it many times, she had memorized and internalized it just the way she had all those lines when she played Bella in the school play, *Gaslight*. She was worried about two other matters entirely: her looks and her class mates. All but her face and hair were concealed by the kelly green gown with a white collar and the kelly green mortarboard with a gold tassel the school issued for the occasion, nevertheless, her face and hair – she had spent hours, hours, this morning washing her long straight brown hair, which came down below her shoulders, drying it in the sun, combing it, brushing it, fluffing it, worrying about it, since she thought it was her strongest asset. As for her face, she believed she was pretty but looked too adolescent, too innocent, vulnerable,... and the girl sitting next to her, Regina Cox, kept sighing after every *young woman who*. How much did Regina resent her? How many others sitting beside her and behind her in their green gowns resented her? Why did Mr. Thoms have to go on with so many *young woman whos*? In this moment of stardom, with practically everybody she knew looking on, she felt almost as much guilt as triumph. But triumph she did feel, and guilt has been defined as the fear of being envied.

"... a young woman who this fall will become the first graduate of Alleghany High School to attend Dupont University, which has awarded her a full scholarship." The adults in the rows of folding chairs behind her murmured appreciatively. "Ladies and gentlemen... Charlotte Simmons, who will deliver the valedictory address."

Tremendous ovation.

From *I am Charlotte Simmons* by Tom Wolfe, published by Jonathan Cape.
Reprinted by permission of The Random House Group Ltd.

2 Determine what event in college life the passage focuses on.

.....

3 The extract is a mixture of narrative and dialogue.

Who speaks in lines l. 13-26 ? .....

Who is described in lines 27-47 ? .....

4 Complete the following table with the principal information about the two main characters.

Character	Past	Present	Future

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5 Match these aspects of Charlotte's personality with the appropriate qualifying adjective:

	Ordinary	Extraordinary
academic results		
athletic results		
physical appearance		
concern about looks		

6 Decide how the members of the audience feel about Charlotte and quote the text to justify:

	Approve	Disapprove	Justification (quote from text)
parents			
students			

7 True or false? Justify by quoting the text.

- **a.** Charlotte is preoccupied by her speech.

  ❒ True ❒ False .....

- **b.** She participated in the school drama club.

  ❒ True ❒ False .....

- **c.** She is dressed like the girl in the photograph on the title page of this sequence.

  ❒ True ❒ False .....

- **d.** She likes her hair more than her face.

  ❒ True ❒ False .....

Check your answers.

Activity 6

Now let's study Mr Thoms speech more carefully. Read it again.

"... a young woman who – well, ordinarily we never mention SAT scores here at the school, first, because that's confidential information, and

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second, because we don't like to put that much emphasis on SATs in the first place" – he paused – "but just this once, I have to make an exception. I can't help it. This is a young woman who scored a perfect sixteen hundred on the SAT and perfect fives on four different advanced placement tests, a young woman who was chosen as one of North Carolina's two Presidential Scholars and went to Washington, to the White House – along with Martha Pennington of our English department, who was honored as her mentor and met with the ninety eight students and their mentors representing the other forty nine states of our nation and had dinner with the President and shook hands with him, a young woman who, in addition, was one of the stars of our cross country team, a young woman who this fall will become the first graduate of Alleghany High School to attend Dupont University, which has awarded her a full scholarship." "Ladies and gentlemen... Charlotte Simmons, who will deliver the valedictory address."

1 You remember the speech techniques we studied in Sequence 3. Which ones are present in Mr Thoms' speech?

Technique	✓	Example
Alliteration		
Facts		
Opinions		
Repetition		
Emotive language		
Statistics		
Three (rules of)		
Rhetorical questions		
Superlatives		
Pronouns		
Flattery		

2 In your opinion, what is the main purpose (objective) of Mr Thoms' speech?

❒ to show the rest of the school how mediocre they are in comparison with Charlotte;

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- ❒ to impress the audience with his rhetorical skills;
- ❒ to show Charlotte how outstanding (exceptional) he thinks she is;
- ❒ to impress his listeners with Charlotte's accomplishments and to communicate his pride for the school;
- ❒ to impress his listeners with the accomplishments of his school.

❸ Sum up Mr Thoms' message in one sentence.

.....

.....

.....

Language work

Before you move on to the next part, take time to learn any vocabulary you did not know.

Do these two quick exercises to check:

Match the antonyms:

to conceal	to appreciate
to wash	weakest
long	short
strongest	to dry
to resent	to show

Match the synonyms:

scholar	appearance
fall (US)	autumn (GB)
looks	a hero(ine)
to deliver an address	to give a speech
a star	student

Check your answers.

Activity 7

FACT FILE

valedictory address – a farewell oration (especially one delivered during graduation exercises by an outstanding member of a graduating class).

Charlotte Simmons has been chosen to make the valedictory address at the graduation ceremony of her high school on account of her excellent school record.

The purpose of this valedictory address is to speak to both parents and faculty on behalf of all the other graduates.

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❶ What ideas do you expect Charlotte to express?

- ❒ confidence in her ability to make a good speech
- ❒ a personal message to her parents
- ❒ a personal message to her teachers
- ❒ a personal message to her classmates
- ❒ an expression of gratitude to parents from all the students
- ❒ an expression of gratitude to faculty from all the students
- ❒ an expression of particular gratitude to Mr Thoms from all the students
- ❒ an expression of personal pride at her achievements
- ❒ an expression of pride at the achievements of all the students
- ❒ an expression of disappointment for the students who did not obtain satisfactory results
- ❒ an expression of delight at leaving school
- ❒ an expression of nostalgia
- ❒ ideas exclusively related to life at school
- ❒ ideas that relate to life in general, not specifically to school
- ❒ other .....
- ❒ other .....

❷ Now read Charlotte's speech and tick (✓) the ideas she actually does express on the right of the above statements.

Mr Thoms, members of the faculty, alumni and friends of the school, parents, fellow students, fellow classmates, John Viscount Morley of Blackburn once said, 'Success depends on three things: who says it, what she says, and how she says it. And of these three things, what she says is the least important'. So I can't guarantee this is going to be a success. Nevertheless, I will try to examine some of the lessons we seniors have learned over the past four years, lessons that lie beyond the boundaries of the academic curriculum. We have learned to appreciate many things that we once took for granted. We have learned to look at the special environment in which we live, as if it were the first time we

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had ever seen it. There is an old Apache chant that goes, "Big Blue Mountain Spirit, the home made of blue clouds, I am grateful for that mode of goodness there." We seniors, centuries later, are grateful, too, grateful for the way we have learned that achievement cannot be measured in the cold calculations of income and purchasing power. We have learned that cooperation, pulling together as one, achieves so much more than going it alone, and than twenty acting strictly in their own self-interest. For as the great naturalist John Muir wrote in *John of the Mountains*, "The mountains are fountains of men as well as of rivers, of glaciers, of fertile soil. The great poets, philosophers, prophets, able men whose thoughts and deeds have moved the world, have come down from the mountains – mountain-dwellers who have grown strong there with the forest trees in Nature's workshops." Thank you.

❸ Which speech techniques are present in Charlotte's speech?

Technique	✓
Alliteration	
Facts	
Opinions	
Repetition	
Emotive language	
Statistics	
Three (rules of)	
Rhetorical questions	
Superlatives	
Pronouns	
Flattery	

FACT FILE

John Viscount Morley of Blackburn (1838-1923): English Liberal statesman who gained fame as a man of letters, particularly as a biographer for French and American philosophers. An active politician: Member of Parliament, Chief Secretary for Ireland and Secretary of State for India.

John Muir (1838-1914) spent his life exploring, writing about and fighting for the great wilderness areas of America – even though he was a Scot. His exploration of the New World led to him being hailed as the founding father of the modern environmentalist movement.

❹ List the aspects of Charlotte's speech that do not figure in Mr Thom's speech and that are symptomatic of her academic excellence. (There are at least two different aspects.)

.....

.....

❺ Sum up Charlotte's message in one sentence.

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Check your answers.

Activity 8

Mr Thom's and Charlotte's speech have different purposes, but also common points.

❶ Look back at the scripts of both speeches and pick out the following elements.

	Mr Thom's speech	Charlotte's speech
How the speaker addresses the listeners		
The words to indicate (s)he represents a group of people		
The words to indicate (s)he is speaking in his / her own name		
How the speaker ends the speech		

Check your answers.

❷ Now listen to Mr Thoms' speech and annotate it at the same time. You may use the "pause" button.

/ pause **↗ upward intonation** **↘ downward intonation**

"... a young woman who well, ordinarily we never mention SAT scores here at the school, first, because that's confidential information, and second, because we don't like to put that much emphasis on SATs in the first place" – he paused – "but just this once, I have to make an exception. I can't help it. This is a young woman who scored a perfect sixteen hundred on the SAT and perfect fives on four different advanced placement tests, a young woman who was chosen as one of North Carolina's two Presidential Scholars and went to Washington, to the White House – along with Martha Pennington of our English department, who was honored as her mentor and met with the ninety eight students and their

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mentors representing the other forty nine states of our nation and had dinner with the President and shook hands with him, a young woman who, in addition, was one of the stars of our cross country team, a young woman who this fall will become the first graduate of Alleghany High School to attend Dupont University, which has awarded her a full scholarship." "Ladies and gentlemen... Charlotte Simmons, who will deliver the valedictory address."

❸ Practise reading the speech marking the pauses and giving the correct intonation.

❹ Now annotate Charlotte's speech as you think it should be spoken.

Mr Thoms, members of the faculty, alumni and friends of the school, parents, fellow students, fellow classmates, John Viscount Morley of Blackburn once said, 'Success depends on three things: who says it, what she says, and how she says it. And of these three things, what she says is the least important'. So I can't guarantee this is going to be a success. Nevertheless, I will try to examine some of the lessons we seniors have learned over the past four years, lessons that lie beyond the boundaries of the academic curriculum. We have learned to appreciate many things that we once took for granted. We have learned to look at the special environment in which we live, as if it were the first time we had ever seen it. There is an old Apache chant that goes, "Big Blue Mountain Spirit, the home made of blue clouds, I am grateful for that mode of goodness there." We seniors, centuries later, are grateful, too, grateful for the way we have learned that achievement cannot be measured in the cold calculations of income and purchasing power. We have learned that cooperation, pulling together as one, achieves so much more than going it alone, and than twenty acting strictly in their own self-interest. For as the great naturalist John Muir wrote in *John of the Mountains*, "The mountains are fountains of men as well as of rivers, of glaciers, of fertile soil. The great poets, philosophers, prophets, able men whose thoughts and deeds have moved the world, have come down from the mountains – mountain-dwellers who have grown strong there with the forest trees in Nature's workshops." Thank you.

❺ Record yourself giving Charlotte's speech.

CD 2

Compare your recording with the model.

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4 Developing your speaking skills

Just as Mr Thoms organised a graduation ceremony for his senior students and their parents, Coach Simet (look back at Activity 4 if you need to refresh your memory) organised an end of year celebration for the swim team.

Activity 9

You are going to use Simet's notes to write out his speech:

Notes

address to swimmers, parents & faculty

pleasure: to celebrate end of year

pride: progress of swimmers & final results in championship

special satisfaction: swimmers' progress in academic subjects

desire to honour 2 swimmers in particular:
1) Jackie Kibble (Grade B in Speech)
2) Adam Mott: A's in all 7 subjects
= complete reversal of mid-year situation

thanks to Icko (driver) & Jones (key swimmer)

hope for even better results next year

First, make sure your language skills are up to standard:

1 For each noun indicate the corresponding adjective and verb as in the example:

Noun	Adjective	Verb
pleasure	pleased	to please
pride		
desire		
thanks		
hope		

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❷ See how many different expressions you can use to express the same ideas as in the example.

Noun	Expression
pleasure	I am pleased to… It gives me great pleasure to… Nothing pleases me more than to…
pride	
desire	
thanks	
hope	

Check your answers.

Activity 10

❶ Now write out the speech using Simet's notes to guide you:

Notes	Written speech
address to swimmers, parents & faculty	
pleasure: to celebrate end of year	
pride: progress of swimmers & final results in championship	
special satisfaction: swimmers' progress in academic subjects	
desire to honour 2 swimmers in particular: 1) Jackie Kibble (Grade B in Speech) 2) Adam Mott: A's in all 7 subjects = complete reversal of mid-year situation	
thanks to Icko (driver) & Jones (key swimmer)	

❷ Record yourself giving the speech and try to speak using the notes and not the written version.

Listen to your recording to assess your performance.

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Comment évaluer votre prestation à l'oral ?

Cochez la case qui correspond le mieux à votre prestation.

Votre discours s'enchaîne	❒ plutôt difficilement	❒ plutôt facilement	❒ de manière fluide
Vous faites	❒ beaucoup d'erreurs grammaticales	❒ peu d'erreurs grammaticales	❒ rarement des erreurs grammaticales
Vous utilisez	❒ un vocabulaire assez limité	❒ un vocabulaire plutôt varié	❒ un vocabulaire riche et varié
Vous parlez avec	❒ un accent étranger assez prononcé	❒ un accent étranger peu perceptible	❒ une bonne prononciation
Dans votre exposé	❒ vous décrivez les lieux et les personnes en termes simples ; vous enchaînez quelques phrases	❒ vous développez les points importants avec précision et vous communiquez vos sentiments et vos réactions	❒ vous racontez la scène en détail ; vous insistez sur les points importants et les éléments significatifs
	= Niveau A2 niveau attendu pour le Brevet	= Niveau B1 niveau attendu fin 3e/2de	= Niveau B2 niveau visé pour le baccalauréat

En fonction de votre diagnostic, vous savez ce que vous devez faire. Vous devez travailler sur deux plans :

1. La qualité de la langue

Le vocabulaire et la grammaire s'apprennent, surtout en analysant vos erreurs pour y remédier. L'accent étranger se perd en écoutant et en répétant beaucoup. Pour développer la fluidité (l'enchaînement fluide de votre discours), il faut parler et parler encore !

2. La richesse du contenu

Plus vos idées sont riches et développées, mieux c'est. Au final, on voudrait que vous puissiez faire preuve des mêmes aptitudes rédactionnelles en anglais qu'en français. A ce stade de votre cursus, il ne suffit plus de s'exprimer dans une langue correcte : il faut montrer que vous êtes capable de mener une réflexion approfondie, de prendre position et d'argumenter pour défendre vos idées (tout en montrant une prise en compte des idées d'autrui).
Encore une fois, c'est l'entraînement qui vous permettra de progresser !

CD 2
Enr.17

Now compare your version with the model answer.

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Activity 11

Now imagine how Mott replies on behalf of all the members of the swim team:

You are going to use Mott's notes to write out his speech. If you are confident, speak directly without writing the speech first, or if you need to prepare more methodically, write the speech, then speak.

Notes

address to coach & driver, parents & faculty

pleasure: to travel to meets every weekend

pride: progress in Swimming and in academic subjects

special satisfaction :
1) development of team spirit
2) self-confidence of individuals

thanks to coach – play hard, laugh loud

regret: good school results => admission to college (= leave high school)

Record yourself giving the speech. (Try to speak using the notes and not the written version).

Listen to your recording and assess your performance using the same table as in Activity 10. Have you made progress?

CD 2

Now compare your version with the model answer.

Comment améliorer l'oral ?

Si vous avez plus de difficultés à l'oral qu'à l'écrit (ce qui est généralement le cas quand on apprend une langue), il faut profiter des occasions qui se présentent pour s'entraîner.

Cela veut dire bien sûr, faire toutes les activités d'écoute et de production orale proposées dans ce fascicule, mais vous pouvez aussi utiliser les supports audio associés aux scripts proposés dans le corrigé pour affiner votre écoute et votre prononciation.

CD 2

Reprenez les modèles pour les discours tout en regardant les scripts dans le corrigé (Activity 10 & 11) pour réaliser les entraînements suivants :

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1. Entraînement à la compréhension

Écouter l'enregistrement sans regarder le script tant que vous le comprenez. Dès qu'un problème de compréhension se pose, regardez la transcription : il se peut que la lecture vous éclaire aussitôt, mais il se peut aussi que vous ayez besoin de consulter un dictionnaire pour surmonter l'obstacle si c'est le mot et non pas la prononciation qui vous pose problème.

2. Entraînement à la production orale

Écouter l'enregistrement tout en regardant le script et essayez de reproduire ce que vous entendez. Au début, procédez par segments de phrases, puis par phrases entières, puis par paragraphes entiers pour essayer de reproduire le rythme. Si possible, enregistrez-vous et comparez votre production avec l'original.

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5 Extending your knowledge of American culture

Activity 12

Read the following literary extract, then do the activities that follow.

Some four months before Dr. Fensterman came to the house to make his offer to Coleman's parents, Coleman found himself one Saturday in Doc Chizner's car being driven up to West Point, where Doc was going to referee a match between the Army and the University of Pittsburgh. Doc knew the Pitt coach and he wanted the coach to see Coleman fight. Doc was sure that, what with Coleman's grades, the coach could get him a four year scholarship to Pitt, a bigger scholarship than he could ever get for track, and all he'd have to do was box for the Pitt team.

Now, it wasn't that on the way up Doc told him to tell the Pitt coach that he was white. He just told Coleman not to mention that he was colored.

"If nothing comes up," Doc said, "You don't bring it up. You're neither one thing or the other. You're Silky Silk. That's enough. That's the deal." Doc's favorite expression: that's the deal. Something else Coleman's father would not allow him to repeat in the house.

"He won't know?" Coleman asked.

"How? How will he know? How the hell is he going to know? Here is the top kid from East Orange High, and he is with Doc Chizner. You know what he's going to think, if he thinks anything?"

"What?"

"You look like you look, you're with me, and so he's going to think that you're one of Doc's boys. He's going to think that you're Jewish."

Coleman never regarded Doc as much of a comedian – nothing like Mac Machrone and his stories about being a Newark cop – but he laughed loudly at that one and then reminded him, «I'm going to Howard. I can't go to Pitt. I've got to go to Howard. For as long as Coleman could remember, his father had been determined to send him, the brightest of the three kids, to a historically black college along with the privileged children of the black professional elite.

"Coleman, box for the guy. That's all. That's the whole deal. Let's see what happens."

Except for educational trips to New York City with his family, Coleman had never been out of Jersey before, and so first he spent a great day walking

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around West Point pretending he was at West Point because he was going to go to West Point, and then he boxed for the Pitt coach against a guy like the guy he'd boxed at the Knights of Pythias – slow, so slow that within seconds Coleman realized that there was no way this guy was going to beat him, even if he was twenty years old and a college boxer. Jesus, Coleman thought at the end of the first round, if I could fight this guy for the rest of my life, I'd be better than Ray Robinson. It wasn't just that Coleman weighed some seven pounds more than when he'd boxed on the amateur card at the Knights of Pythias. It was that something he could not even name made him want to be more damaging than he'd ever dared before, to do something more that day than merely win. Was it because the Pitt coach didn't know he was colored?

From *The Human Stain* by Philip Roth, published by Jonathan Cape. Reprinted by permission of The Random House Group Ltd.

1 Annotate the text (as you learnt to do in Activities 4 & 5) to identify the key elements.

2 Read the text again carefully and use your intelligence and your general knowledge to do the following: (Make complete sentences to practise your writing skills.)

▶ **a.** Explain what West Point is.

.....

.....

▶ **b.** Explain Doc Chizner's ambitions for Coleman.

.....

.....

▶ **c.** Explain whether Coleman shares these ambitions or not.

.....

.....

▶ **d.** Explain how Doc Chizner intended to present Coleman to the Pitt coach.

.....

.....

▶ **e.** Explain the reason for Coleman's laughter.

.....

.....

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▶ **f.** Explain the outcome (result) of the fight and how Coleman justifies it.

.....

.....

▶ **g.** Explain whether this result was predictable or not.

.....

.....

❸ Sum up the ideas illustrated in this passage about:

- how Americans choose their college education;
- how ethnic minorities are considered by the White majority;
- how ethnic minorities react to this attitude.

Check your answers.

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6 On the road to autonomy

Prenez connaissance de la tâche suivante avant de réaliser les activités proposées. (N'oubliez pas que le but de cette partie de la séquence est de vous permettre de consolider vos acquis.)

The situation Coleman has been offered a four-year scholarship by Pittsburgh University as a result of his performance in the fight at West Point. He has also been accepted at Howard University as a result of his brilliant academic results – with the promise of a four-year scholarship too.

Your task Play the role of one of the adults (either Doc Chizner or Coleman's mother) and record the 'speech' in which you try to persuade Coleman to make the right choice using rational arguments rather than strong emotions. You want him to feel that he has made his decision without being influenced! (You must speak for at least two minutes.)

Activity 13

Prepare your arguments

Rules to respect: You must speak for a minimum of 2 minutes. You may speak with your notes in front of you BUT you must not read your notes, you must talk naturally.

Guidelines: Your talk needs to be structured and well-argued. You need to develop the following points:

1. Your pride at Coleman's success. (introduction)
2. The importance of choosing the right school for his future. (general notions)
3. In what way each alternative has certain advantages. (general notions)
4. In what way each alternative has certain drawbacks. (general notions)
5. Recommendations to help Coleman reach his decision. (rationality)
6. Conclusion: confidence in Coleman's decision.

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Note down your arguments:

Pride at Coleman's success	
Importance of choosing the right school	
Advantages of each alternative	
Drawbacks of each alternative	
Recommendations	
Conclusion: confidence in Coleman's choice	

Activity 14

Prepare your expressions and vocabulary

Note down the words and structures you can use at each stage.

Pride at Coleman's success	
Importance of choosing the right school	
Advantages of each alternative	
Drawbacks of each alternative	
Recommendations	
Conclusion: confidence in Coleman's choice	

Check your answers if you need help.

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Activity 15

❶ **Make your talk, sitting comfortably and imagining Coleman is standing in front of you. Record yourself at the same time.**

❷ **Listen to your recording and assess your performance, according to these criteria.**

Criterion	Yes	No
The opening lines indicate the importance of what I have to say.		
My voice is loud and clear.		
My intonation goes down at the end of sentences.		
I clearly articulate words.		
I sound confident (there are no gapfillers such as ‘err, hem).		
I use colloquialisms such as “you know”, “right”, “okay”, “so”.		
I use changes in volume to good effect.		
I use changes in pace (= speed) to good effect.		
It is easy to follow the structure of my speech.		
The end of the speech is convincing.		

CD 2

Compare your final version with the model script and the CD. ■

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